

Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

VP Platform Reliability Engineering | SRE | Incident Management | Observability | Capital Markets | Multi-Cloud

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EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE Lead

IRIS Software - India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

Sep 2020 - Present Hyderabad, India

- Led incident management and problem management for ADP SRE - instituted blameless postmortem culture and Ansible + Python automated remediation, cutting **MTTR by 40%+** across mission-critical HCM platforms.
- Designed and deployed full-stack **observability stack (Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, AppDynamics)** for ADP; built alerting pipelines enabling real-time root cause analysis and proactive bottleneck identification.
- Defined and governed **SLOs, SLIs, and error budgets** across multi-client cloud platforms (BMO, ADP, Charles Schwab) - establishing reliability thresholds tied to business commitments.
- Built **ADP's SRE org from 4 to 40 engineers** across India, Canada, and the US; stood up Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from ground zero with reliability reviews, incident governance, and on-call frameworks.
- Established **chaos engineering practices (Keptn)** for ADP SRE - proactively identifying fault scenarios and hardening platform reliability under real-world failure conditions.
- Delivered **modeas high-throughput deployment platform** handling 200+ builds/hour - eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually and improving deployment cadence by 600%.
- Managed on-call rotations and escalation frameworks for a 35-member SRE team; embedded structured **ITIL-aligned incident, problem, and change management** across the engineering organisation.
- Led end-to-end on-premise to **AWS migration for BMO CCB** - CDK-enabled ECS Fargate/Lambda pipelines with HA/DR built in; drove FinOps optimisation reducing cloud waste across the AWS estate.
- Deployed **GenAI risk summarisation assistants** on Azure and AWS for BMO, reducing manual analysis effort across BCRG and LTS pipelines.
- Presented reliability strategies, SRE metrics, and incident outcomes directly to **VP and C-suite stakeholders** at ADP, Charles Schwab, and BMO.

Automation Technology Specialist

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020 Toronto, Canada

- Established **SRE principles and observability standards** within RBC Insurance's DevSecOps programme - introduced incident classification frameworks and reliability-focused deployment gates across **250+ applications** in a regulated capital markets and insurance environment.
- Operationalised the **DORA framework** across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance via Azure DevOps - tracking Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR as primary engineering health metrics.
- Implemented **Splunk log aggregation and alerting pipelines** integrated with CI/CD workflows, enabling proactive detection and rapid response to production incidents.
- Designed the **Robo Deployment Framework** - PowerShell-native CI/CD orchestration with self-service pipelines for Windows services, database deployments (SSIS, Oracle, SQL Server), and enterprise app workloads; reduced onboarding from **5 weeks to 5 hours** (98% reduction).
- Governed enterprise-wide change management across 250+ applications - enforcing **SOX/GDPR compliance** and audit-ready change transparency; integrated SonarQube, Jenkins, UrbanCode, JFrog Artifactory for shift-left security.
- Led enterprise migration of **250+ applications across 60+ teams** from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub, enabling modern CI/CD and self-service provisioning at scale.

SUMMARY

20+ year platform reliability and SRE leader with deep expertise in incident management, observability engineering, and automation for mission-critical capital markets and FinTech platforms. Built and scaled SRE organisations from the ground up - growing teams from 4 to 40 engineers across global banking clients (ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, RBC) - while cutting MTTR by 40%+ through Prometheus, Grafana, AppDynamics, and Ansible-driven automated remediation. Expert in SLO/SLI governance, chaos engineering (Keptn), and full-stack troubleshooting across Linux, Windows, Kubernetes, and distributed data platforms (Kafka, Redis, MongoDB, Elasticsearch).

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- MTTR -40% - ADP SRE**
Reduced MTTR by 40%+ via Ansible automated remediation, Dynatrace + AppDynamics alerting, and blameless postmortem-driven improvement across mission-critical HCM platforms.
- 4 → 40 SRE Org Scale**
Scaled ADP's SRE organisation from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US; built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from zero in a single quarter.
- 200+ Deployments/hr**
Designed modeas deployment platform handling 200+ builds/hour; eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually and improved deployment cadence by 600%.
- 5 Weeks → 5 Hours**
Robo Deployment Framework cut application onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction) across 250+ applications and 60+ teams at RBC.

Automation Architect

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada (Insurance & Capital Markets)

Feb 2017 - Jun 2018 Toronto, Canada

- Designed **fault-tolerant Kubernetes and Helm-orchestrated deployment pipelines** enabling zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms.
- Led RPA practice delivery - automating **80+ applications and 250+ components** across Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, and Mainframe stacks.
- Pioneered Cognitive and Intelligent Process Automation (CPA/IPA) through the Robotics Market Street programme; standardised Python-based automation frameworks at scale.

Technology Manager

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd. - Noida, India (Client: Adobe)

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017 Noida, India

- Architected and delivered **zero-downtime business application migration** during Adobe's data centre relocation - owned full plan, execution, and production cutover across all workloads.
- Led SAP HANA upgrades and HTTP/7 enablements; executed schema redesign and ETL re-engineering migrating Informatica to SQL Server 2012 at enterprise scale.

Sr. SDET - QA, Automation & Production Engineering

Microsoft Corporation - India

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014 Hyderabad, India

- Dual mandate as Sr. SDET and Production Engineering owner - full quality and operational lifecycle for Sales & Marketing platforms serving US, EMEA, and APAC; sustained **99.99% uptime** over 7 years.
- Managed production operations end-to-end: incident response, RCA, infrastructure administration (**Windows and Linux**), and cross-team coordination for zero customer-impacting incidents.
- Built QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD pipelines - eliminating manual testing bottlenecks and accelerating release confidence across multi-stack application workloads.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified SRE (iSRE)

iSRE Institute

AWS Solutions Architect - Associate

Amazon Web Services - 2026

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer

CNCF - 2025

GCP Professional Cloud Architect

Google Cloud - 2026

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)

Microsoft

ITIL Certificate in IT Service Operations

Axelos

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence 2024

Woolf University

General Management Program (GMP)

2022

ISB Hyderabad

M.Sc in Computer Science 2002

Osmania University